

XINHANG (OWEN) MA

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EDUCATION

- Washington University in St. Louis** St. Louis, MO
Ph.D. in Computer Science; Advisor: Prof. Yevgeniy Vorobeychik Jan. 2025 – Present
- Washington University in St. Louis** St. Louis, MO
M.S. in Computer Science; Advisor: Prof. Yevgeniy Vorobeychik Jan. 2024 – Dec. 2024
- Thesis: *Towards Verified Vision-Based Neural Network Controllers for Autonomous Lane-Following* [\[link\]](#)
- Washington University in St. Louis** St. Louis, MO
B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics Aug. 2020 – Dec. 2023

CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

- Protecting Language Models Against Unauthorized Distillation through Trace Rewriting
Xinhang Ma, William Yeoh, Ning Zhang, Yevgeniy Vorobeychik
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2026 [\[arXiv\]](#)
- Conformal Reachability for Safe Control in Unknown Environments
Xinhang Ma, Junlin Wu, Yiannis Kantaros, Yevgeniy Vorobeychik
International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems (AAMAS), 2026 [\[arXiv\]](#)
- Learning Vision-Based Neural Network Controllers with Semi-Probabilistic Safety Guarantees
Xinhang Ma, Junlin Wu, Hussein Sibai, Yiannis Kantaros, Yevgeniy Vorobeychik
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2026 [\[arXiv\]](#)

PREPRINTS

- AutoDojo: Adaptive Black-Box Attacks Reveal the Limits of IPI Defenses and Task-Specification Effects in LLM Agents
Xinhang Ma, Taoran Li, Chaowei Xiao, Zhiyuan Yu, Ning Zhang, Yevgeniy Vorobeychik
arXiv preprint, 2026 [\[arXiv\]](#)

TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

- Protecting Language Models Against Unauthorized Distillation through Trace Rewriting
Oral presentation, Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) 2026
- LLM Security: Jailbreak and Prompt Injection Attacks and Defenses
Guest lecture, Adversarial AI, Washington University in St. Louis 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Vorobeychik Lab

Washington University in St. Louis

St. Louis, MO

Jan. 2024 – Present

- Study attacks and defenses for indirect prompt injection in LLM agents, including an adaptive black-box attack framework used to measure how far existing IPI defenses actually generalize, and how much of their apparent robustness depends on task specification.
- Develop methods that protect deployed language models against unauthorized distillation by rewriting reasoning traces, preserving answer accuracy while degrading the value of the traces to a distilling adversary.
- Develop safety guarantees for learned controllers, combining conformal prediction with reachability analysis to certify vision-based neural network policies under unknown dynamics.

Washington University in St. Louis

Undergraduate Independent Study, Advisor: Prof. Yevgeniy Vorobeychik

St. Louis, MO

Aug. 2023 – May 2024

- Maintained and extended the software stack of a 1/10th-scale F1Tenth autonomous vehicle, tuning perception and control for lane following in a miniature city environment.

TEACHING

Adversarial AI

Mentored Teaching Experience (guest lectures, course design)

Washington University in St. Louis

2026

Data-Driven Privacy and Security

Teaching Assistant

Washington University in St. Louis

2025

Analysis of Algorithms

Teaching Assistant

Washington University in St. Louis

2024

Data Structures and Algorithms

Teaching Assistant

Washington University in St. Louis

2022, 2023

SERVICE

Conference Reviewer: AAAI 2027, NeurIPS 2026, L4DC 2026